Appendix B

Major Derivatives Exchanges

Chapter 2 described what an exchange does; this appendix says who they are. The list covers venues that matter either because of their volume or because they own a benchmark that the rest of the market prices against, and for each it names the group that owns it, where it sits, and what actually trades there.

Two warnings belong before the tables.

Ownership and product lists move. Exchanges are acquired, renamed, and delisted; contracts are launched and retired. What follows reflects the position in early 2026, and any specific claim here should be checked against the venue's own contract specifications before it is relied on for a trade. *The structure is more durable than the details*, which is the reason the appendix closes with Section B.8 rather than with a table.

And there is no single ranking. Section B.1 explains why the two ways of measuring an exchange's size disagree by orders of magnitude, and why almost every published league table is answering a question the reader did not ask.

B.1 HOW TO READ THE TABLES

The two standard volume measures do not rank the same way, and the gap between them is not small.

Contracts traded counts tickets. It is the figure the Futures Industry Association publishes and the one exchanges quote in press releases. *It is also almost meaningless across venues*, because contract sizes differ by factors of thousands: an Indian index option on a lot worth a few thousand dollars and a Eurex Bund futures contract on €100,000 of notional each count as one.

Notional traded counts economic exposure. It ranks quite differently, and it is the figure that matters for anything in Chapters 27 and 40, where exposure and capital are the subject.

The consequence is plain. By contracts, the largest derivatives exchange in the world is in India; by notional it is in Chicago, and the two are not close in either direction. A reader who sees "largest exchange" in a headline should establish which measure is meant before drawing any inference about where risk actually sits.

Two further cautions apply to any of these figures.

Open interest is the better measure of what is held. Volume measures turnover, and a venue dominated by same-day expirations—Section 23.1's 0DTE flow, or the Indian weekly options market—generates enormous volume against small open interest. *Turnover and exposure are different questions.*

And exchange-traded volume is not the whole market. The largest interest rate and credit

markets in this book are over-the-counter and clear through the houses of Section 2.4 rather than trading on any exchange listed here. *A directory of exchanges is a map of the listed market, not of derivatives.*

B.2 NORTH AMERICA

Exchange	Group	Principal derivatives
CME	CME Group	SOFR and Fed funds futures, E-mini S&P 500 and Nasdaq-100, FX futures, live cattle
CBOT	CME Group	US Treasury futures across the curve, corn, soybeans, wheat
NYMEX	CME Group	WTI crude, Henry Hub natural gas, refined products
COMEX	CME Group	Gold, silver, copper
Cboe Options	Cboe Global Markets	SPX options, VIX options, listed equity options
Cboe Futures (CFE)	Cboe Global Markets	VIX futures
ICE Futures U.S.	ICE	Sugar, coffee, cocoa, cotton, Russell 2000, USD index
Nasdaq PHLX, ISE, GEMX, MRX	Nasdaq	Listed equity and index options
MIAX Options, Pearl, Emerald, Sapphire	Miami International Holdings	Listed equity options
MGEX	Miami International Holdings	Hard red spring wheat
Montréal Exchange	TMX Group	Three-month CORRA futures, Canadian government bond futures, S&P/TSX 60 futures

The concentration is the point. Four of the eleven venues above belong to CME Group, and between them they carry the US benchmark contract in interest rates, equity indices, energy, and metals. *No other jurisdiction has anything comparable*, and Section B.8 returns to what that means for the clearing houses behind them.

One entry records a transition this book has already described. Montréal's BAX contract referenced CDOR and was retired with it; the three-month CORRA futures contract is its replacement, and Section 4.4's account of the benchmark transition is what that line in the table is about.

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B.3 EUROPE

Exchange	Group	Principal derivatives
Eurex	Deutsche Börse	Bund, Bobl, Schatz and Buxl futures, Euro Stoxx 50 futures and options, single-stock options, €STR and Euribor futures
ICE Futures Europe	ICE	Brent crude, gasoil, SONIA and Euribor futures, FTSE 100
ICE Endex	ICE	Dutch TTF natural gas, the European gas benchmark
London Metal Exchange	HKEX	Copper, aluminum, zinc, nickel, lead, tin, on the prompt-date structure
Euronext	Euronext	CAC 40, AEX, FTSE MIB, milling wheat, rapeseed, corn
EEX	Deutsche Börse	German and French power, EU emission allowances, gas
Nasdaq Nordic	Nasdaq	OMXS30 futures and options, Nordic equity derivatives
Borsa İstanbul (VIOP)	Borsa İstanbul	Equity index and single-stock futures, currency
Moscow Exchange	MOEX	Domestic index, FX, and commodity contracts; largely closed to international participants since 2022

Europe's map is drawn differently from America's, and the difference is the subject of Section B.8. Eurex clears its own contracts; most European over-the-counter interest rate risk clears at LCH, which is owned by neither an exchange group nor its members in the way a vertical silo is.

Two entries carry episodes from Chapter 41. The London Metal Exchange's nickel contract is where the March 2022 suspension and cancellation of trades happened, and the Dutch TTF gas contract is where the 2022 margin spiral of Section 41.11 ran. *Both are cases where the venue itself became the risk*, which is why they are named here rather than left to a footnote.

B.4 ASIA-PACIFIC

Exchange	Group	Principal derivatives
National Stock Exchange	NSE India	Nifty 50 and Bank Nifty index options and futures; the largest venue in the world by contracts traded
BSE	BSE India	Sensex and Bankex index options
MCX	MCX India	Gold, silver, crude oil, natural gas
Osaka Exchange	JPX	Nikkei 225 futures and options, TOPIX, JGB futures
TOCOM	JPX	Energy, rubber, precious metals
Korea Exchange	KRX	KOSPI 200 options and futures, three-year KTB futures
HKEX	HKEX	Hang Seng and HSCEI futures and options, MSCI contracts, USD/CNH futures
Singapore Exchange	SGX	FTSE China A50, Nikkei 225, iron ore, rubber, FX futures
TAIFEX	TAIFEX	TAIEX futures and options
ASX	ASX	SPI 200, three- and ten-year Treasury bond futures, 90-day bank bill
Bursa Malaysia Derivatives	Bursa Malaysia	Crude palm oil (FCPO), the global benchmark

The Indian entry deserves the qualification the table cannot carry. NSE has led the world

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by contract count for several years, on a market dominated by weekly index options with very small lot sizes—which is Section B.1's warning in its purest form. *Regulatory measures from late 2024*—larger lot sizes, and a limit of one weekly expiration per exchange—were introduced precisely because the authorities concluded that retail turnover of that shape was not serving the participants generating it. Volumes fell sharply and the ranking survived, which tells you how large the gap to second place was.

And one entry records a contract that moved countries. SGX's Nifty futures, long the offshore venue for Indian index exposure, transitioned in 2023 to NSE's international arm at GIFT City. *An offshore benchmark returning onshore is unusual*, and it is the mirror image of the Chinese pattern described next.

B.5 MAINLAND CHINA

China's exchanges are treated separately because the market is structured differently: six futures exchanges, each with a defined product remit, under a single regulator, with foreign access granted contract by contract rather than venue by venue.

Exchange	Location	Principal derivatives
Shanghai Futures Exchange (SHFE)	Shanghai	Copper, aluminum, zinc, nickel, rebar, hot-rolled coil, gold, silver, rubber
Shanghai International Energy Exchange (INE)	Shanghai	RMB-denominated crude oil, TSR20 rubber, low-sulfur fuel oil; open to overseas investors
Dalian Commodity Exchange (DCE)	Dalian	Iron ore, soybean meal and oil, palm olein, corn, coking coal, coke, LLDPE, LPG
Zhengzhou Commodity Exchange (ZCE)	Zhengzhou	PTA, methanol, cotton, sugar, rapeseed meal and oil, urea, soda ash, glass
China Financial Futures Exchange (CFFEX)	Shanghai	CSI 300, CSI 500, SSE 50 and CSI 1000 index futures and options; 2-, 5-, 10- and 30-year government bond futures
Guangzhou Futures Exchange (GFEX)	Guangzhou	Industrial silicon, lithium carbonate
Shanghai and Shenzhen Stock Exchanges	Shanghai, Shenzhen	ETF options on broad-based indices

The division of labor is administrative rather than historical, which is why the product split is so clean: ferrous and energy in Dalian, chemicals and soft commodities in Zhengzhou, non-ferrous metals in Shanghai, all financial contracts at CFFEX, and the new-energy complex at Guangzhou, which was created in 2021 for exactly that purpose. *No Western exchange group was assembled that tidily*, because none of them was assembled at all—they merged into their present shape.

Two features matter for anyone pricing these contracts. The exchanges impose daily price limits and position limits far more actively than their Western counterparts; and the government bond futures at CFFEX use a 3% notional coupon against the 6% of the CME's Treasury contracts, which changes which bond is cheapest to deliver.

Access is by contract, not by venue. INE's crude contract was built from the outset for overseas participation, and specific DCE and ZCE contracts have been opened since; most of the rest remain domestic. *Hong Kong is the offshore complement*, which is where the USD/CNH futures in Section B.4's table fit.

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B.6 LATIN AMERICA, THE MIDDLE EAST, AND AFRICA

Exchange	Location	Principal derivatives
B3	São Paulo	DI interest rate futures, Ibovespa futures and options, USD/BRL futures, single-stock options
MexDer	Mexico City	TIIE interest rate futures, IPC index, USD/MXN
Gulf Mercantile Exchange	Dubai	Oman crude, the principal East-of-Suez sour benchmark
ICE Futures Abu Dhabi	Abu Dhabi	Murban crude
Saudi Exchange	Riyadh	Index and single-stock futures
Johannesburg Stock Exchange	Johannesburg	Equity index and single-stock futures, currency, white and yellow maize, wheat

B3 is larger than its profile suggests. Its DI contract—a futures on the domestic interbank rate—trades in volumes that place it among the world's most active interest rate contracts by count, and Brazilian hedgers use it in place of the swap market that dominates elsewhere. *Where a listed contract is liquid enough, it displaces the over-the-counter equivalent*, which is the observation Chapter 2 makes in the abstract and Brazil demonstrates.

The two Gulf entries exist because of a gap in the crude benchmark map. Brent and WTI are light and sweet; much of what actually moves from the Gulf to Asia is neither, and both Oman and Murban were listed to give that barrel a transparent price. Section 36.9's discussion of benchmark grades is what these contracts are for.

B.7 CRYPTO VENUES

Chapter 37 treats these instruments; what belongs here is the distinction between the venues that trade them, because it is sharper than in any other asset class.

Regulated futures exchanges list bitcoin and ether futures and options under the same rules as any other contract. CME is much the largest of these, and its contracts are the ones institutional participants can hold without a separate custody and counterparty framework.

Offshore crypto-native venues carry most of the volume. They list the perpetual futures of Section 37.3—a contract with no delivery date, held in line with spot by the funding-rate mechanism—and they clear, custody, and match on the same balance sheet, which is the vertical integration Section 37.9 identifies as the structural risk. *The largest of them trade more notional than the regulated venues by a wide margin*, and Deribit has long been the dominant venue for crypto options specifically.

The distinction is not about size but about what fails when something fails. A CME position is protected by the clearing arrangements of Chapter 2 and the segregation rules of Chapter 8. *On a venue that is simultaneously exchange, clearing house, and custodian, those three protections are one balance sheet*, and Section 37.10's account of what that has cost is the reason the appendix separates them.

B.8 WHAT THE MAP SHOWS

Four structural facts survive the details, and they are the reason to read a directory of this kind at all.

The listed market is concentrated in a small number of groups. CME Group, ICE, Cboe, Nasdaq, Deutsche Börse, HKEX, JPX, NSE, and B3 account for the large majority of exchange-traded derivatives volume worldwide. *Competition happens between groups, not between the venues inside them*, which is why a group's several exchanges rarely list the same contract against each other.

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Liquidity does not migrate. A benchmark contract is a network good: it is liquid because everyone uses it, and everyone uses it because it is liquid. *Competing exchanges have repeatedly listed identical contracts against an incumbent and repeatedly failed*, which is why the Bund is at Eurex and Treasuries are at CBOT decades after either could in principle have moved.

The vertical silo is the dominant model outside Europe. An exchange that owns its clearing house captures the margin as well as the fee, and—more consequentially—makes positions non-fungible with any competitor's. Europe's separation of LCH from the trading venues is the main exception, and Section 2.10's discussion of clearing concentration is where the consequences are worked out.

And the exchange is not where most derivatives risk sits. Interest rate swaps, credit default swaps, and the structured products of Chapter 35 are over-the-counter instruments; they clear centrally, but they do not trade on a venue in this appendix. *The exchanges hold the price discovery and the retail flow; the dealers and the clearing houses hold the exposure.* Anyone reading this list as a map of where the risk is has read it as the opposite of what it is.

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